

Parks Commission Recreation - Report 6/10/2026

Dunbar Community Center

Youth Programs: Baseball season is ongoing, Star Student banquet was held at Stephens

Youth Athletics: Track registration is starting soon, season during summer.

Facility Improvements (Planned): New office furniture for a couple of offices has been delivered

Southwest Community Center

Youth Programs

Summer Laureate & Youth Engagement: Enrollment is at 100 participants it is filled and reg. is closed. camp dates: June 8th - July 23rd, Monday -Friday 8:00a.m.-5:00p.m.

Youth Dance Class: Saturdays 9:00 -11:00 a.m. Average: 10 - 12 participants, \$10 per participant

Free Art Night: from 6pm-8pm, monthly membership. They will make a Mason Jar Lamp.

Youth Athletics

Soccer: Panther Soccer teams will celebrate their season with a pool party when outdoor pool opens.

Baseball: Southwest Panther 4u, 6u, 8u, and 10u teams practice weekly and league play has begun.

Adult Programs

Southwest Steppers Dance Workout Class: Dancing at Dusk at River Front Park. 2 events, (May and June). Social Media posted.

Art Class: for ages 18+ last Tuesday of each month 12pm – 2pm

Walking Club: Members and guest experiences walking the trails at Southwest Com. Center with a staff, miles are recorded and incentives received periodically. Currently 4 members

Low-Impact Senior Workout: Video-based program with about 15 members and guests aged 65 and up.

Pickleball: Beginners Thursday mornings 9:00 am-10:00 am. Enrollment will open again July 23.

- **May Events:** Loteria Night, **5/2:** Cinco de Mayo Food Truck Fiesta, **5/2:** Water Safety Classes (youth), Soft opening pool operation, and SWLR Bike Rodeo, (partnered with Dee Brown and RB4K), **5/9:** Workforce RV on-site Job application program, **5/12:** Consulate, **5/14-16**
- **May 2026 Updates:** Installation of the new ice machine (Change plans must order much larger ice machine), Upgrades to the game room add more excitement and entertainment (Budget concerns), Project site plan for playground area upgrades (Chad updated we are waiting on plans from Ron), Washer and Dryer will be installed at the facility to assist with cleaning of towels, uniforms and mops (Walk through of the location for instalment was completed last week)

Stephens Community Center

- **Attendance:** 2,436
- **Activities:** MacArthur Reading every Tuesday 3:30 – 4:30pm. Star Student Banquet May5, 2026.
- **Star Student Afterschool Program:** Reached 72% for spring semester.
- **Youth Sports Program:** Youth T-Ball/Baseball is going well, plays at West Central. Cheerleaders (30 participants).
- **Adult Activities:** 40 & over Men's League going well and nearing the end of season.
- **Facility Vacancies:** Recreation Programmer, 2-Part-Time Custodians or 1-Full Time Custodian.
- **Maintenance:** Air Unit motor broken. (has been ordered, waiting on delivery)

West Central Community Center

- **Youth Sports:** Soccer games were Saturdays (indoors), 44 participants season is over. Baseball/Tee Ball registration 212
- **Classes:** Karate 15, Dance 10
- **Events/Activities:** Easter Egg Hunt April 4, 200 participants, Parkview girls award banquet, Family Fun Fest April 18 (games & health screenings), LRFD Truck, HR Workman Comp training
- **Rentals:** 8 rentals in April
- **Maintenance:** Baseball fields updates and maintenances have begun. New fencing around the tee ball field is up and new dugout 2 and bleachers are being updated for fields 2 & 3
- **Staffing:** 1 Act. Assistant & concessionaire positions are open

ELR Community Center

- **Trainings** Cybersecurity/Series
- **Events:** Star Student Banquet at Stephens CC
- **Community Use:** Estem Athletics, Grounds, Outdoor courts and park areas used 3–5 days/week for recreation, trainings, and fitness.
- **Maintenance:** Grounds upkeep ongoing; tennis courts in need of refurbishment.
- **Meetings:** Staff meetings, Star Student Banquet, CAPRA, Work Order, Neighborhood meeting May 11 (Cancelled)-next meeting June 8.

Senior Affairs

- **Community Outreach:** West Central Seniors - Mobile Grocer Van on Friday May 29, Baptist Health held their monthly outreach, monthly health screening all locations and food distributions (Dunbar/East LR & Southwest).
- **Programs:** East LR/Southwest Mother's Day activity, Dunbar had speaker from Arch Well Health. ELR/West Central had a session on Alzheimer's and ELR a Baptist Podcast. West Central had Arch Well Health (Paint & Sip).
- **Monthly Activities:** Chair volleyball, bean bag baseball, Birthday celebrations, Bingo/connect bingo, Bean Bag Baseball, Pickle Ball, Dominoes, Arts & Crafts, Guest Speakers, Field Trips, Bible Study, bowling, painting, Line Dancing, Mind Bending, Ring Toss, Silver Foxes Dance Class, Senior Chair Fitness, walking club, Quilting, Puzzles, Adult Coloring, Jewelry & T-Shirt Making, Skip-Bo, Card/Table Games, and Free play

Therapeutic Recreation

- **Camp Enrollments:** (1) Adult Day Program, enrolled - 15 (2) TR Youth Summer Day Camp- Location TBD - enrolled (full) 20 campers, Dates for both - **June 8- July 17, 2026.**
- **Special Annual Event:** 24th Annual Therapeutic Recreation Arts Festival **May 1, 2026**, Approx. 600 attendees.
- **Community Outings:** DeGray Lake Boat Tour, **May 14, 2026**, Little Rock Zoo **May 12, 2026.**

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

- **Fitness Programs:** The Commit to Fit 6-Week Challenge 65 people registered
- **Aquatics Programs: Outdoor Pool Opened:** May 1, 2026; Learn to Swim Program has 176 participants, ages 3 and up. The aquatics program continues to offer **7 classes.** (Indoor Pool CLOSED for roof repair May 1, 2026).
- **Memberships/Revenue/Attendance:**
Memberships – 2,700 new 1,778 Revenue -\$500,000.00 in total \$251.714.84



Attendance – 150,000 total in attendance 50,389 Report at the end of each month

- **Events:** Outdoor Pool: Dollar Day May 23, 2026 Time: 10:0am Cost: \$1.00
- **Upcoming: Fitness in the Park:** Bootcamp Style Date: June 6, 2026 Time: 10:00am Location: War Memorial – North Lawn Cost: Free

The Centre at University Park (Currently Under Renovation)

Youth Athletics

- **Baseball/Tee-Ball** - Season will began May 11, at West Central ballfields. —**Baseball:** 286 registered. **Tee-Ball:** 83 registered.
- **Upcoming:** Pitch, Hit, and Run advertising continues. Track & Field site location search continues.

Adult Athletics

- **Interstate/Allsop/Murry Park Programs:** Hillcrest organization softball league at Allsop park is going well as well as the Kickball club out at Interstate. Volleyball Court rentals at Murray Park have been picked up and we continue as the weather gets better. Allsop ballfield reservations continue to increase as we are done with the Hillcrest neighborhood association finishing up their league.
- **Murry Park Volleyball court:** Had a great month of May for rentals for the volleyball courts at Murray and now already have reservation for 8 dates and June for 3 courts every Wednesday.
- **Adult Basketball Program:** The 40 and over basketball league is over as of May 28, 2026, and we will start tournament play on June 8, 2026 at Stephens Community Center.
- **LR Parks Summer Day Camp:** Registration for City Summer Day camp is complete all sites are full. The program is June 8, 2026 - July 23, 2026.
- **Kanis Park:** Arkansas Baptist used Kanis park for baseball practice. The kick ball club reservation was for every other Wednesday from March 25 – May 28, 2026. Rentals at Kanis park have been reserved fields by an organization that requested 24 days for the month of June and July for the baseball field.

Rebsamen and First Tee Golf

- **Maintenance:** @First Tee (New sod in the tee boxes, will be ready soon. Driving ranges are good shape). Repainting exterior (quoted) @ Rebsamen,
- **Recognition:** Golf Course Superintendent, Clint Sellers, who participated in the Folds of Honor Hero 100 golf marathon. He completed the 100 holes on May 26, 2026, raising a little over \$1000 in donations.
- **Events First Tee:** U.S. Kids golf tournament **5/2/2026**, ASGA Monk Wade Junior Classic **5/9-10/2026**

Rebsamen Tennis

- **Tournaments:** Little Rock Open May 25 -31; Wild Card for pro tournament is next week, May 19-22; Jim Cox Classic, May 1-3, was canceled due to poor numbers
- **Community:** Community Impact day big success – May 13 from 1-4 PM, 9 people came to help clean facility/grounds.
- **Season:** Spring Team Tennis is in full swing (over 60 team tennis teams)
- **Maintenance:** Power washing and court resurfacing were done.

Museum of Arkansas Military History

- **Attendance:** May - 3,023, visitors have come from 31 other states as well as Canada, England, Guatemala, Italy, Scotland, and Germany.
- **Staff:** David Collins and Jessica Gates are completing programming for the Summer Day Camp off-site program at the Community Centers, as well as Chicot and Romine sites starting in June. David Collins curated the museum's newest exhibition, *Manufacturing Victory in Arkansas: Supplying the Battlefield and Changing the Homefront During World War II*, which opened to the public on May 28. Shane Lind presented off-site programming to the Therapeutic Recreation Arts Festival on May 1.
- **Programs:** Afterschool (Dunbar, Stephens, & JA Fair (188 students)
- **Gift Shop Sales:** \$1,594.65 (May) YTD Total: \$5,171.55, a 22% increase over 2025.
- **Fundraising:** \$3,173 (May) YTD Total: \$14,378.75 **Donations:** Including a donation of \$2,500 from the law firm of Wright, Lindsey and Jennings for programming sponsorship in 2026.
- **Exhibits:** *Thomas Hart Benton* through July 31, 2026
- **Movies MacArthur:** *The Day the 60s Died: The Kent State Shootings*, on May 19. 85 people
- **Special Events:** : **May 1** – 17th Annual “History on the Run” 5K Race, 7 pm; **May 9** – “On the Road with Mark Christ – War in the Territory,” 7 am – 7 pm; **May 19** - *The Day the 60s Died: The Kent State Shootings*, Movies at MacArthur, 6:30 - 8:30 pm; Memorial Walk - A local group began and ended its 3.5 mile walk at the Arkansas Korean War Veterans Memorial on May 21.
- **Looking Ahead:** June – July – Summer Day Camp Program Off-site and Field Trips; June 5 Professional Development Workshop, *Women in the Military*, June 6 – Congressman French Hill’s “Send-Off for the Service Academy Cadets” Reception, June 14 – Concert, “Stars and Stripes Celebration for Flag Day” with Little Rock Winds, 7 pm, June 16 – Movies at MacArthur, *The Forgotten War*, 6:30 – 8 pm, June 25 – Korean War Remembrance Ceremony, 10 am – 1 pm

Outdoor Recreation

- **Installation:** Installed a disc golf course at War Memorial Park along with "Glow" disc golf equipment (lights for baskets and glow-in-the-dark discs).
- **Promotions:** Information table at Therapeutic Arts Festival, Volunteer Park Rangers, Jr Park Rangers, AR Canoe Club, Mud Run, Orienteering Course at Allsopp, South and/or Boyle Park.
- **Programs:** Adding kayaks and road bikes. **Mountain Bike Rides:** Tuesdays/Thursdays at Allsopp Park, north
- **Registration:** 2026 Squatch Till You Drop trail running event is open 20 registered.
- **Trainings:** cyber security and safety trainings, completed Parks Self-Assessment Tool Survey
- **May Events Held:** Monday evening mtn bike rides: 6pm-8pm, Boyle, River Mtn and Allsopp parks. May dates- 4th, 11th, 18th, 25th; Wednesday evening road rides: 6pm-8pm, leaving from Murray Park (Big Banana); May dates-6th, 13th, 20th, 27th; Group hikes: 3rd Saturday of each month 10am: Conner Park; May 16th